Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date	2 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

An empathy map is a straightforward visual that gathers what is known about a user's behaviors and attitudes. It lets a team see through the user's eyes, understand what they say, think, do and feel, and identify the pains and gains that should guide the solution.

In this project, empathy maps were created for the two people most affected by today's laptop ordering process: the employee who needs the device and the IT procurement coordinator who delivers it.

Step-1: Empathy Map for the Requesting Employee

Persona: Riya, new employee

Needs a standard laptop ready before her first working day

Says

- "When is my laptop going to arrive?"
- "Who can give me an update?"
- "I can't begin work without a device."

Thinks

- "Why does a standard laptop need this many approvals?"
- "Is my request stuck, or just slow?"
- "This ought to be simple."

Does

- Emails IT and her manager asking for status
- Fills in a request form with details IT already holds
- Waits, then follows up again and again

Feels

- Anxious about joining without equipment
- Frustrated that she cannot see progress
- Unsure whether the request is moving

Pains

- No clear status once the request is submitted
- Long waits for manual approvals
- Having to repeat information in the request

Gains

- A single catalog item for a standard laptop
- Automatic approval with clear status updates
- A laptop ready on day one

Step-2: Empathy Map for the IT Procurement Coordinator

Persona: Arjun, IT procurement coordinator

Fulfils laptop orders from stock or from vendors

Says

- "I keep typing in the same details."
- "Has this request been approved yet?"
- "Do we have this model in stock?"

Thinks

- "Most of these requests look identical."
- "I shouldn't have to chase every approval."
- "One missed step holds up the whole order."

Does

- Checks inventory manually
- Chases managers for their approvals
- Raises purchase orders and asset records by hand

Feels

- Stretched thin by repetitive tasks
- Worried about mistakes and delays
- Frustrated by constant status questions

Pains

- Manual steps between request and delivery
- Frequent status inquiries
- Mistakes caused by re-keying data

Gains

- Flow Designer takes care of routine steps
- Time freed up for exceptions and vendor negotiation
- Accurate records and fewer interruptions

Key insight: both people are held back by the same thing: a process built on manual hand-offs that offers no clear status. Automating standard laptop orders with Flow Designer solves the problem for both.